Spells

The twenty-five core spells, the ten mastery spells, how casting works, and the items that cast them

Kingdoms Call reference sheet. Data file v2026.10.15-1202. Generated 2026-10-19 from the repository (branch at that date). Numbers are what the engine uses today, read straight from its tables; where a figure comes from the rulebook text instead, the section says so.

Five schools, five core spells each at level 1, plus one mastery spell at 7 and one at 9. A spell can work as an action (a phase order), in personal combat, or as battle magic before an army clash; many do more than one. Effects are worked out on the caster's level counted to 5.

What to look for when reviewing

- Does each school have a comparable mix of action, combat and battle-magic uses? (White 4 action / 2 combat / 2 battle; Psychic 5 action / 3 combat / 2 battle; Illusory 4 action / 2 combat / 0 battle; Elemental 3 action / 2 combat / 2 battle; Necromancy 4 action / 3 combat / 2 battle).
- Are the damage spells in step with each other at level 5 (Lightning 5–15, Fireball 20%/round for 3 rounds, Hand of Death 60% for 40%, Telekinetic Storm 27%)?
- Which action spells have no spell item (the items cast at a flat 95%).
- Whether battle-magic effects are worth a cast slot next to the action use.

Where this comes from

- Data file: SPELL_DEFS_P (flags: phase = action, encounter = combat; target). Engine: BATTLE_MAGIC_SPELL_NAMES, NPC_SCHOOL_SPELL.
- Rulebook: Magic: The Five Schools, The Spellbook, Mastery spells. Rulings R-010, R-017, R-024, R-028, R-031, R-053, R-112, R-113, R-115.

Casting rules

Rule	What it is
Cast chance	30% + 10% per school level, cap 95%: 40% at 1, 80% at 5. The same roll for an action, battle magic or a duel, and for a guardian hero (R-115). Items add +10% a level past 5; mastery L8 +10% per school; some discoveries add more.
How many	Action spells per school per turn: 1 at levels 1–2, 2 at 3, 3 at 4–5. Combat spells per school per fight: 1 at level 1, 2 from 2; each spell once per fight.
Effect level	Every effect reads the level counted to 5. Levels 6–9 buy cast chance and the mastery spells only.
Weakness	A guardian weak to the school cannot resist: cast at a flat 95%, damage and every effect doubled.
Wards	A guardian's school ward takes −20/30/40/50% off the cast chance by grade; stun wards turn stuns aside; spell resistance cuts damage.
Spell items	Two items per core action spell cast it at a flat 95% with no skill and no slot (as at least a level-3 casting). No item casts a mastery spell.
Missed targets	A character-targeted spell whose target rode out earlier is never worked and costs nothing. Province spells and Clairvoyance always work.
Graves	Battlefield graves decay 10% a turn (5% in Undead provinces). Necromancy 1 senses whether graves lie in every province entered.

White Magic

Spell	Needs	Used as	Target	Effect	Items that cast it
Resurrect	Core (level 1)	Action	character	Action: bring a slain hero back to life at full health — without their possessions. The body must lie in your province and must not already have been raised this turn. Your own most recently fallen KING may be recalled this way (his body is borne home), and reclaims the throne; a rival's king never can.	Phial of the Dawn, Saint's Knucklebone

Spell	Needs	Used as	Target	Effect	Items that cast it
Part Sea	Core (level 1)	Action	province	Action: any sea OR land province you are in or adjacent to. A sea province (including a land province flooded to sea earlier this turn) becomes plains for the rest of this turn; fleets cannot enter or leave it from the next phase onward. Cast on still-dry land it finds no sea to part. Cancels Flood.	Rod of the Parted Waters, Pilgrim's Sandal
Bless Province	Core (level 1)	Action	province	Action: a province you are in or adjacent to gains +60% tax base this turn (+80% for Divine realms; +100% when the Divine KING casts it in person). The blessed ground is also WARDED: a 50% + 5% per White level chance (counted to level 5, so 50–75%) to turn aside each enemy Flood, Earthquake, Plague or Part Sea cast there this turn. Only one Bless can affect a province at a time (does not stack).	Censer of Plenty, Harvest Icon
Holy Symbol	Core (level 1)	Action, Combat, Battle magic	none	Action: cleanses the province the caster stands in of all its battlefield dead — every grave there is laid to rest and can no longer be raised by any necromancer. Combat: the opponent suffers −8% per caster level to hit and is seared for 6% of its health (both ×1.5 against undead and fiends), and the caster recovers 10% of their own. Battle magic: all enemy undead units fight at 75% base strength.	—
Spiritwrack	Core (level 1)	Combat, Battle magic	none	Combat: for 1 round, plus 1 per two White levels (at most 3), the target cannot cast spells, use its powers or use archery (reaching for one, it attacks instead), and its melee damage is halved. Battle magic: all missile units fight at half base strength.	—
Sanctuary	Mastery 7	Action	province	Action (White 7): ward a province you are in or adjacent to. Enemy armies fighting there this turn do so at −25% strength.	—
Divine Judgment	Mastery 9	Action	character	Action (White 9): smite an enemy hero in your province — heavy holy damage to them, and several of the units they lead are destroyed.	—

Psychic Magic

Spell	Needs	Used as	Target	Effect	Items that cast it
Charm	Core (level 1)	Action, Combat	character	Action: hire a wandering hero in your province for free (you still pay upkeep), or seize a general's command of an armyless enemy hero for the rest of the turn (reverts to its owner at end of turn). Combat: doubles the chance of a later successful Flee.	Locket of Sweet Words, Silver Tongue Charm
Oratory	Core (level 1)	Action	character	Action: every army travelling with the target (self or an ally in your province) gains +1 quality level for the rest of the turn. Not cumulative.	Speaker's Laurel, Horn of the Assembly
Clairvoyance	Core (level 1)	Action	character	Action: everything that happens to the target enemy character becomes known to you for the rest of the turn, reported in your Realm Events. Cannot be cast on a neutral or wandering hero. Only one Clairvoyance may be active at a time — a new casting replaces the old.	Seer's Bowl, Eye of the Far Watch
Psychic Blast	Core (level 1)	Action, Combat, Battle magic	character	Action: the target loses 2 skill levels, each drawn from a random owned skill (the two picks may be the same skill). Combat: the opponent can do nothing at all for 1 round, plus 1 per two Psychic levels (3 at Psychic 5), unless a stun ward turns it. Battle magic: negates the enemy commander's Druid skill for the battle.	Shard of the Screaming Mind, Migraine Stone
Telekinetic Storm	Core (level 1)	Action, Combat, Battle magic	character	Action: a number of the target's units equal to your skill level are struck — Green units are destroyed outright, and every other struck unit PERMANENTLY drops one experience level; a skeletal unit struck by it shatters outright. Combat: deals 12% of the target's max HP, plus 3% per Psychic level (15% at 1, 27% at 5), as damage; the caster takes a quarter of that. Battle magic: negates the enemy commander's Tactical bonus.	Whirlwind Bracelet, Gauntlet of the Unseen Hand
Mass Confusion	Mastery 7	Action	character	Action (Psychic 7): an enemy hero in your province loses all Tactical command in their next battle this turn.	—
Dominate	Mastery 9	Action	character	Action (Psychic 9): seize the mind of an enemy hero in your province — up to half the armies they lead defect to you.	—

Illusory Magic

Spell	Needs	Used as	Target	Effect	Items that cast it
Illusory Terrain	Core (level 1)	Action	province	Action: a province you are in or adjacent to shows enemies a false, ever-shifting terrain on their maps. Any enemy who fights there is disoriented — each of their units fights as if caught in the worst terrain for its kind, always at least a 15% strength reduction. An enemy hero who enters dispels it at the end of that turn; otherwise 20% chance to fade each turn.	Cartographer's Prism, Mirage Glass
Phantasmal Armies	Core (level 1)	Action	character	Action: phantasmal duplicates of 10% per caster level (counted to level 5, minimum 1) of the humanoid armies led by you or an allied hero in your province join that force for the rest of the turn — they fight but never appear in the roster, and melt away if their originals fall or the force is beaten.	Banner of Shadows, Drum of Ten Thousand
Hide Lairs	Core (level 1)	Action	province	Action: veil an entire province you are in or adjacent to — every lair within becomes invisible to all other players, who cannot discover any lair there (though any they already found remains theirs). 20% chance to fade each turn.	Fogbinder's Lantern, Moth-Wing Veil
Invisibility	Core (level 1)	Action, Combat	none	Combat: enemies suffer −10%, and a further −4% per Illusory level (−14% at 1, −30% at 5), to hit the caster for the fight, and the caster gains +30% to Flee. Action: cast on yourself — 80% chance that no enemy player sees you (sightings, spies, encounter targeting, the map) for the rest of the turn.	Ring of Vanishing, Hood of No-Face
Mirror Image	Core (level 1)	Combat	none	Combat: conjures a phantom duplicate of your opponent that they must fight while you concentrate (taking no other actions). Each round they may disbelieve it (4% per total skill level); casting it again dissipates both images.	—
Phantom Host	Mastery 7	Action	none	Action (Illusory 7): phantasmal duplicates of 15% per caster level (min 1) of the monsters/creatures you lead join your force for the rest of the turn — they fight but never appear in your roster, and melt away if their originals fall or the force is beaten.	—
Veil	Mastery 9	Action	none	Action (Illusory 9): for this phase and the next, you and the armies you lead vanish from enemy sight and cannot be targeted or affected by any hostile spell.	—

Elemental Magic

Spell	Needs	Used as	Target	Effect	Items that cast it
Lightning Bolt	Core (level 1)	Combat, Battle magic	none	Combat: deals 1–3 damage per caster level (counted to level 5) to the opponent. Battle magic: the bolt leaps from army to army — a number of enemy armies equal to your level each lose 20% of their strength for the battle.	—
Fireball	Core (level 1)	Combat, Battle magic	none	Combat: burns the target for 10% of its health each round, plus 2% per Elemental level (12% at 1, 20% at 5), for three rounds. Battle magic: the strongest enemy army unit has its base strength halved for the battle.	—
Earthquake	Core (level 1)	Action	province	Action: a province you are in or adjacent to yields no tax revenue at the end of this turn.	Hammer of the Deep Root, Fault-Stone
Flood	Core (level 1)	Action	province	Action: a land province you are in or adjacent to acts as a sea province for the rest of the turn (cancels Part Sea).	Conch of the Drowned Bell, Tide-Warden's Urn
Elemental Summon	Core (level 1)	Action	none	Action: summon a random elemental (Air, Fire, Earth, Water or Darkness) to fight under your command for the rest of the turn, then it dissolves. Roughly as strong as a powerful primal unit.	Elementalist's Brazier, Four-Wind Compass
Chain Lightning	Mastery 7	Action	character	Action (Elemental 7): arcing lightning tears through an enemy hero in your province — 30% of the units they lead are caught, and each caught unit has a 50% chance to be destroyed.	—
Cataclysm	Mastery 9	Action	province	Action (Elemental 9): devastate a province you are in or adjacent to — every enemy force there loses units, and the province tax base is permanently reduced to 0.	—

Necromancy

Spell	Needs	Used as	Target	Effect	Items that cast it
Control Undead	Core (level 1)	Action, Combat, Battle magic	character	Action: seize one random undead army unit from a neutral/enemy character in your province — or cast it on your own province to sense the battlefield dead lying there, unit by unit, and to learn which of the SURROUNDING provinces hold graves of their own (that they do, never how many or what). Combat: an undead foe cannot act for a number of rounds equal to your Necromancy level (counted to 5), unless a stun ward turns it. Battle magic: one random enemy undead unit defects to your side.	Leash of Bone, Grave-Warden's Whistle
Skeletal Armies	Core (level 1)	Action	none	Action: raise the most experienced dead army units lying in your province as skeletal versions under your command — 1 unit at Necromancy 1–2, 2 at Necromancy 3–4, 3 at Necromancy 5+.	Reaper's Bell, Ossuary Key
Curse	Core (level 1)	Action, Combat, Battle magic	character	Action: EVERY skill the target has is halved (rounded down) for the rest of the turn. Combat: the target's best combat ability is halved for the fight. Battle magic: the enemy commander's best combat-affecting skill (Tactical, Druid or Naval) is halved for the battle.	Hexwright's Needle, Blackened Wishbone
Hand of Death	Core (level 1)	Combat	none	Combat: 10% per Necromancy level (at most 60%) to strike for 40% of the enemy's maximum health (×1.1 with Death's Finger Ring).	—
Plague	Core (level 1)	Action	province	Action: in your province or an adjacent one, each humanoid army unit has a (10% + 5%/level) chance to drop an experience level; survivors are immunised (half chance thereafter). The plague then spreads to adjacent provinces (15% each per phase) until turn's end. Not cumulative.	Vial of the Weeping Rot, Rat-King's Crown
Raise Wraiths	Mastery 7	Action	none	Action (Necromancy 7): raise the strongest of your province's battlefield dead as an elite Wraith — whose Wraith's Touch permanently withers a highest-experience enemy unit each battle it fights.	—
Death's Dominion	Mastery 9	Action	none	Action (Necromancy 9): the fallen of your province rise en masse — raise several skeletal units at once from its battlefield graves, each risen one experience level higher.	—

Summary by school

School	Core spells	Action	Combat	Battle magic	Spell items	Action spells with no item
White Magic	5	4	2	2	6	Holy Symbol
Psychic Magic	5	5	3	2	10	—
Illusory Magic	5	4	2	0	8	—
Elemental Magic	5	3	2	2	6	—
Necromancy	5	4	3	2	8	—

Gaps, questions and things to check

These are observations from reading the data files, the engine and the rulebook together. None of them is a ruling. Each is a question for Toby or a place where two sources disagree.

#	Observation
1	Illusory has no battle-magic spell at all; Elemental and White have two each, Necromancy three. An Illusory caster adds nothing to an army battle until Phantasmal Armies is cast beforehand.
2	Elemental has only three action spells (Earthquake, Flood, Elemental Summon) where the other schools have four or five, and Lightning Bolt and Fireball are the only pure combat spells in the game besides Mirror Image, Spiritwrack and Hand of Death.
3	Action spells with no spell item (see the summary) cannot be cast by a non-mage; check that list is deliberate (combat-only spells have none by design).
4	Hand of Death is a 60% chance (at Necromancy 6+, counted "at most 60%") for 40% of max HP, capped by the half-HP rule (R-080). Against a 60 HP hero that is 24. Fireball at level 5 does 20% a round for three rounds (60%). Compare these in the Hunting Rumours odds.
5	Psychic Blast as an action removes 2 skill levels permanently and lowers the victim's wage (R-024). It is the only permanent skill loss in the game; is that balance wanted next to Curse (temporary)?
6	Charm resistance grows 30% per Charm (R-017, open question). Charm doubling the Flee chance in combat is a small combat effect for a level-1 slot.

#	Observation
7	Spell descriptions quote some figures "counted to level 5" and some not (Lightning Bolt says so, Fireball says "at 5"). A single phrasing would help.
8	The rulebook spellbook tables (A/C/B markers) are generated from the data; the data file's "phase" and "encounter" flags, plus BATTLE_MAGIC_SPELL_NAMES, are the truth.